

DEPARTMENT OF GOVERNEMENT MSc MARKING SCHEME

Mark	Descriptive Equivalent for Exams	Descriptive Equivalent for Course work/Class Essays	Descriptive Equivalent for the Dissertation
Outstanding (Distinction) 75+	The below + outstanding in originality	The below + outstanding in originality	The below + outstanding in originality. Publishable in modified form.
Excellent (Distinction) 70 – 75	The below + original ideas and/or argument. Demonstrates a command of theory and evidence.	The below + original ideas and/or argument. Demonstrates a command of theory and evidence.	The below + original ideas and/or argument. Demonstrates a command of theory and evidence.
Very Good (Merit) 65-69	The below + analytically and theoretically sophisticated with a wide and deep knowledge of literature and a superior marshalling of evidence. Capability of doing PhD work.	The below + analytically and theoretically sophisticated with a wide and deep knowledge of literature and a superior marshalling of evidence. Capability of doing PhD work.	The below + analytically and theoretically sophisticated with a wide and deep knowledge of literature and a superior marshalling of evidence. Capability of doing PhD work.
Good (Merit) 60-64	The below + good use of theory and some analytical depth. Deeper knowledge of literature. Good use of a variety of evidence to support the argument.	The below + good use of theory and some analytical depth. Deeper knowledge of literature. Good use of a variety of evidence to support the argument.	The below + good use of theory and some analytical depth. Deeper knowledge of literature. Good use of a variety of evidence to support the argument.
Average (Pass) 55-59	The below + demonstrates some reflection on the readings and lectures and uses supporting evidence fairly well. Minor factual errors allowed.	The below + demonstrates some reflection on the readings and lectures and uses supporting evidence fairly well. Minor factual errors allowed. Sources are accurately documented and presented.	The below + demonstrates some reflection on the literature and uses supporting evidence fairly well. Minor factual errors allowed. Sources are accurately documented and presented.
Satisfactory (Pass) 50-54	A coherent answer to the question showing a basic knowledge of lectures and set and required readings. Some factual errors allowed.	A coherent answer to the question showing a basic knowledge of lectures and set and required readings. Some factual errors and lapses in documentation of sources allowed.	A basic question answered with a coherent argument demonstrating a basic knowledge of relevant literature and empirical evidence. Some factual errors and lapses in documentation of sources allowed.
Unsatisfactory (Condonable Fail) 40-49	Anything less than the above, but some understanding of the subject demonstrated. Incomplete and poorly organised answer containing many errors of fact.	Anything less than the above, but some understanding of the subject demonstrated. Incomplete and poorly organised answer containing many errors of fact. Narrow or poor selection of material and flawed understanding of it. Poor presentation.	Anything less than the above, but some understanding of the subject demonstrated. Incomplete and poorly organised answer containing many errors of fact. Narrow or poor selection of material and flawed understanding of it. Poor presentation. Poorly researched and little sign of analytical depth.
Unsatisfactory (Un-condonable Fail) 0 - 39	Anything less than the above. Shallow and little evidence of understanding.	Anything less than the above. Little effort. Shallow and very poorly presented.	Anything less than the above. Little effort. Shallow and very poorly presented.